

The world's largest coal reserves are concentrated mainly in five countries, which have been able to exploit this natural asset for their own industrial development. According to figures published in the BP Statistical Review of World Energy 2020, there are more than one trillion tonnes of proven coal resources worldwide. Global production in 2019 topped 7.9 billion tonnes, with China, India and the US among the world's top coal-producing countries. As of January 2020, the United States has the largest recoverable coal reserves with an estimated 249 billion short tons of coal (23% share of the global total) remaining, according to the U.S. Energy Information Administration.

2. Which of the following countries is the leading country in the reserve of Hard Coal?

- (a) Nepal (b) China
(c) New Zealand (d) India

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

China was at the top in terms of the reserve of hard coal when this question was asked followed by the USA and India. According to the BP Statistical Review of World Energy, 2021 data the USA ranked first in the proven reserve of Anthracite and bituminous coal at the end of 2022 followed by China & India respectively.

3. The highest coal-producing country in the world is-

- (a) India (b) USA
(c) China (d) Russia

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (c)

According to World Mineral Production 2017-21, China ranks first in highest coal production in the year 2021.

4. Common type of coal is –

- (a) Bituminous (b) Sub-bituminous
(c) Anthracite (d) Coke

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Coal is mainly a free carbon mixture of a compound of carbon. Coalification is the transformation of plant matter into coal by chemical process. On the basis of the carbon content, there are generally four types of coal- Anthracite, Bituminous, Lignite and Peat. According to USGS the four type (ranks) of coal are Anthracite, Bituminous, Sub-bituminous and Lignite. The Precursor to Coal is Peat. Among the above four types of coal, bituminous is considered as common type of coal, anthracite is of very good quality and peat is the lowest grade

of coal. More than 90 percent of the total coal obtained in India is found in the Gondwana rocks of ancient times. The Gondwana era coal is mainly of bituminous type.

ii. The Gold

1. Which of the following activities is performed at Coolgardie?

- (a) Coal mining (b) Copper mining
(c) Gold mining (d) Forestry
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

World's maximum Gold reserved is found in Australia. About 68 percent of its gold is derived from Western Australia. Two of the important gold mines Kalgoorlie and Coolgardie are situated in Western Australia.

2. Johannesburg is famous for –

- (a) Gold mining (b) Tin mining
(c) Mica mining (d) Iron-ore mining

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (a)

Johannesburg is the biggest city of South Africa and capital of Gauteng Province. It is famous for its Gold and Diamond Mining.

3. Which of the following countries produced the highest annual gold production (in tonnes) in 2019?

- (a) Russia (b) Australia
(c) China (d) United States of America
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th BPSC (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

According to the available data of World Minerals Production 2017-2021 till the year 2021, China has the highest gold production in the world. Russia, Australia and USA are second, third and fourth Gold Production Countries in the world.

iii. The Aluminium

1. The largest producer of aluminium in the world is –

- (a) France (b) India
(c) U.S.A. (d) Italy

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

According to World Mineral Production 2017-2021. The largest producers of aluminium in the world (in the year 2021) are China > Russia > India > Canada > UAE.